Using AI to Analyze and Strengthen Your Business

Audience Notes — Capital Readiness Program Webinar

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The C.O.R.E. Framework

The C.O.R.E. framework structures your interaction with AI so you get useful, grounded output instead of generic suggestions (Jasimuddin, 2026).

- **Context** — Feed AI your actual business data (spreadsheets, reports, records)
- **Objective** — Tell it exactly what you want with sharp, specific goals
- **Reasoning** — Make it show its work step-by-step
- **Evaluation** — Ask it to critique itself, then verify it yourself

How to Use This Handout

Each prompt below is ready to copy and paste into Claude, ChatGPT, or any AI assistant. The prompts follow the C.O.R.E. framework in order. After each main prompt, a **clarifying follow-up** shows how to dig deeper — this models good practice for iterative AI interaction.

All data files are available at: `github.com/LJKelly3141/crp-webinar-ai`

Click the green **Code** button → **Download ZIP** (no account needed).

Demo 1: Invoice Collections Analysis

Files to upload: `invoices_sample_50k.csv` and `Data_Dictionary.csv`

Combined C.O.R.E. Prompt

Prompt

I've uploaded two files: a billing transactions dataset (`invoices_sample_50k.csv`) and its data dictionary (`Data_Dictionary.csv`). Please analyze this data using the C.O.R.E. framework.
`<context>`
— Billing transactions for a small business
— Each row is one invoice
— Some invoices are open, some paid, some written off
`</context>`
`<objective>`
Identify the top 5 industries with the highest rate of late payments (where DAYS_TO_PAY > 30). For each, report the late payment rate and the average days to pay. Return as a ranked table.
`</objective>`
`<reasoning>`
Think step-by-step. Before producing the table:
— Confirm which fields identify industry and lateness
— Note any data quality issues you had to handle

— Show how you computed the late payment rate
</reasoning>
<evaluation>
After the table, critique your own analysis:
— What are the limitations of this conclusion?
— What biases might exist in how this sample was constructed?
— What would you want to verify before acting on this?
</evaluation>

Clarifying Follow-up (if time)

Can you break the top industry down by payment type (Check vs. Wire Transfer vs. Credit Card) — is the late payment rate driven by one payment method?

Demo 2: Cash Flow Forecasting

File to upload: `Ventura Financial Projections Template Jan 2022 v3.xlsx`

Combined C.O.R.E. Prompt

Prompt

I've uploaded a small business financial projections template. Please analyze it using the C.O.R.E. framework:
<context>
This is a small business financial model
with revenue projections and expense assumptions.
</context>
<objective>
Forecast monthly cash inflows for the next 12 months
based on the revenue assumptions in this workbook.
</objective>
<reasoning>
Walk through your assumptions step by step:
— What revenue line items are you using?
— How are you converting revenue projections to cash inflows?
— What timing assumptions are you making?
</reasoning>
<evaluation>
— What are the biggest risks to this forecast?
— Where might the assumptions break down?
</evaluation>

Clarifying Follow-up

What would happen to the forecast if revenue came in 20% below projections in Q3? Show me the revised monthly cash inflow numbers.

Three Things to Try This Week

1. **Anonymize a file and run a C.O.R.E. prompt.** Remove names, account numbers, and IDs. Upload to ChatGPT or Claude. Use the combined prompt format from Demo 1 or 2 as a starting point.
2. **Add a self-critique prompt to any AI output.** "Audit this for errors or unsupported assumptions." Treat this as a required final step.
3. **Document your AI tools.** List every AI tool and dataset your business uses today — that inventory is the foundation for AI governance.

Try It With Your Own Data

1. **Anonymize** a file from your business — remove names, account numbers, IDs
2. **Upload** it to ChatGPT or Claude
3. **Walk through C.O.R.E.** — Context, Objective, Reasoning, Evaluation
4. **Always verify** — AI assists, you decide

The D.A.T.A. Framework for Sharp Objectives

When writing your Objective prompt, use D.A.T.A. (Jasimuddin, 2026):

- **D**ata Source — Which file or tab to use
- **A**ction — The sharp goal (e.g., "Identify top 5 late-paying industries")
- **T**echnical Constraints — What to exclude (e.g., "Ignore credit memos")
- **A**nswer Style — Output format (e.g., "Return a ranked table")

Level Up Your AI Toolkit

When you're ready to go beyond chat interfaces:

- **Try Claude Code** — AI that works directly with your files and data. Install at `claude.ai/download`.
- **Install Python and R** — free tools for data analysis. Python: `python.org`. R + RStudio: `posit.co/download/rstudio-des`
- **Use GitHub** — version control for your work and easy backup. Sign up at `github.com`. AI can help you learn it.

Contact

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